The ignorance of the Pashtun:

The Pashtun are a nation residing in Afghanistan and in Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Baluchistan. For many years, the Pashtun have suffered from extreme racial insults in Pakistan due to their minority status in Pakistan. Still to this day, they live in poverty and in villages. They lack modern technologies in most places, such as mobile signals, etc., while there are many reasons for their poverty; we will focus on the three main points: terrorism and natural disasters. These problems were the most highlighted by the Pashtun families that were interviewed. While each family's financial and family situation was different, they highlighted these problems the most.

Terrorist is one of the most used racial slurs against the Pashtun community, a slur I myself have encountered as well. To learn from real sources about the current terrorism situation, I asked a Pashtun belonging to the Batani tribe. Residing in FATA (federally administered tribal areas), Ghindola, which is near the Afghan border. They are among those most affected by past terrorism. In his interview, he said that due to terrorism, he currently lives in Dera Ismail Khan, which is furthest from the border, in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa currently studying lawrence college Murree. He said most of these issues were raised due to jihadis' habit of gun-slinging. Terrorist groups like al-Qaeda and the taliban were actually revolutions against the Afghan government when they were successful. They were told to give up their guns and live normal and peaceful lives, but the guns had become too influential in their lives to give up. Thus, they resisted the government's request and started terrorizing the people of KPK and FATA. Actually, many of the terrorists weren't even Pashtun but rather Arabs, Uzbeks, and Tajiks there for revolution. The Pashtuns were forced to participate in terrorism, or else they would face the danger first. Due to this, the government also targeted them as terrorists. While many Pashtuns were terrorists, most had no choice. From both sides, the Pashtuns were harmed. Their lands were terrorized, and businesses were hurt.

One of the other highlighted reasons was the destruction related to floods. In the Pashtun-related areas near the major rivers or mountains, flooding is a major reason. I experienced this firsthand while on a family trip to the Kalam area of the Swat district. During our trip, we noticed that the city was much smaller than we had thought. There was a lot of rubble everywhere, and most of the roads were destroyed. So we decided to ask many of the locals, including our tour guide as well as some shopkeepers. We visited in 2024, and they told us that a great flood came in 2021 in the Swat River. The flood was so devastating that entire hotels were swept away by the flood. In 3 years, Kalam has seen no recovery and the Government has given up on providing Aid to the people of Kalam. Our Guide actually said that they have to gather money themself to build roads and get access to basic human necessities. Actually, after a few months of our visit, another flood hit Kalam. The government has stopped the aid because floods happen every monsoon season, and it is considered a “waste” of budget.

Taking a good look at the interviews, you can notice a pattern. Between the unwanted inclusion in state affairs and the floods, the Pashtuns were abandoned and isolated to rebuild their resources by themselves while their lands were harmed. They were left to figure out their lives on their own. Over the years, the government has stripped the Pashtuns of their right to

adequate justice and representation. This has led to these problems. If the Pashtuns were given proper rights, they would have the daily necessities like the rest of Pakistan.